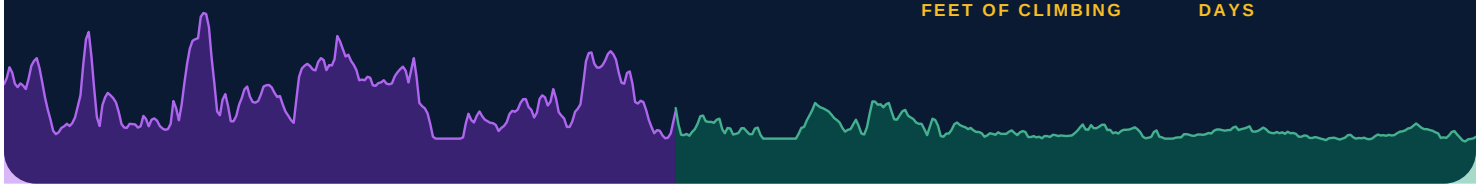
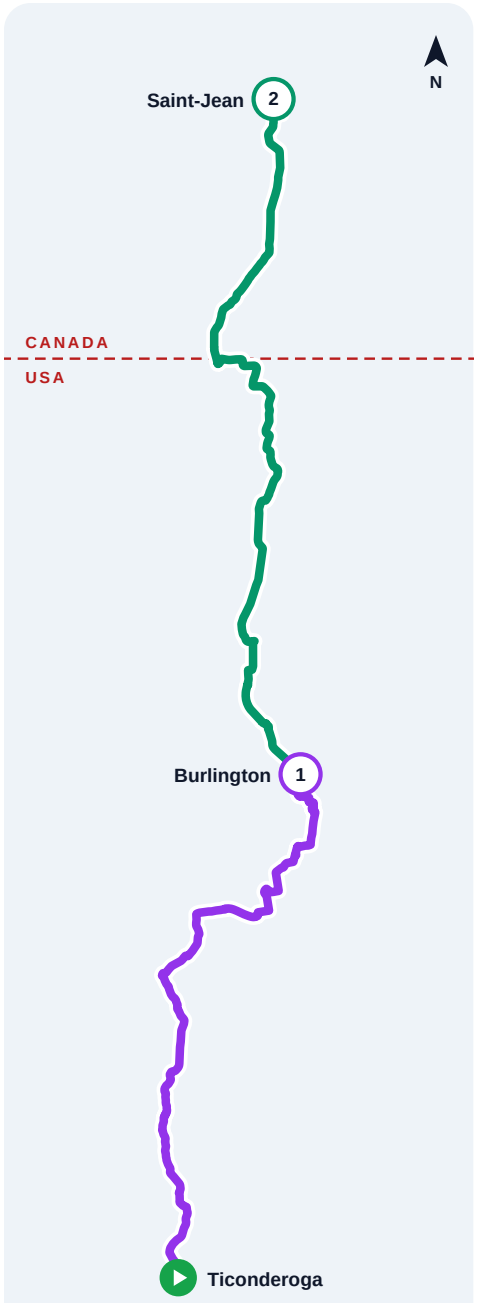
OCTOBER 8 – 9, 2026 · REPLACES 7-DAY DAYS 5 & 6

LAKE CHAMPLAIN ISLANDS VARIANT

133.9	216
MILES	KILOMETRES
+3,200	2
FEET OF CLIMBING	DAYS





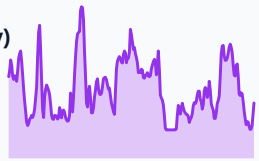
ALT. DAY 1

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8

Ticonderoga, NY to Burlington, VT (via Essex ferry)

61.1 mi · +2,500 ft · 31 cues

Tonight: Hotel Vermont



ALT. DAY 2

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9

Burlington, VT to Saint-Jean-sur-Richelieu, QC

72.8 mi · +700 ft · 32 cues

Tonight: Quality Hotel Centre de Congrès

ABOUT THIS VARIANT

Replaces Days 5 and 6 of the 7-day tour (Thu Oct 8 and Fri Oct 9). Designed for the 7-day tour: the Local Motion bike ferry runs only Fri to Sun (plus Mon Oct 12), so the island day must fall on Fri Oct 9. On the 6-day plan this variant would make the last day about 111 mi. On the 5-day plan the island day would be a Thursday, when the bike ferry doesn't run.

BEFORE YOU ROLL

Where we sleep, what the symbols mean, what to carry

WHERE WE SLEEP

NIGHT	HOTEL	ADDRESS	PHONE
Thu Oct 8 Alt. day 1	**Hotel Vermont** Suggested: book ahead Backup: Courtyard Burlington Harbor, (802) 864-4700	41 Cherry St, Burlington, VT	**(802) 651-0080**
Fri Oct 9 Alt. day 2	**Quality Hotel Centre de Congrès** Suggested: book ahead Backup: Auberge Harris, +1 (450) 348-3821	725 Boul. du Séminaire N, Saint-Jean-sur-Richelieu, QC	**+1 (450) 300-5177**

READING THE CUE SHEETS

- Start of the day
- Continue onto
- Turn left
- Turn right
- Bear left
- Bear right
- Lunch or resupply
- Border crossing
- Ferry
- Point of interest
- Tonight's hotel
- Finish

Coloured bar on each cue = what you're riding on: Bike path · Street · Road shoulder · Unpaved · Ferry

MILE is the distance from the start of that day, measured along the day's GPX track. LEG is how far until the next cue.

GOOD TO KNOW

Alt. day 1, mile 39.0: Charlotte, VT - Essex, NY

FERRY to Charlotte, VT: about 20 min crossing, $6.75 per cyclist. In the early-fall schedule, Essex departures run every 30 min 10:30 AM to 5:30 PM (hourly before and after).

Alt. day 2, mile 10.3: Local Motion Bike Ferry (Seasonal)

BIKE FERRY across the Cut. 2026 fall schedule: Fri 10 AM to 5 PM, Sat and Sun 10 AM to 6 PM, through Mon Oct 12 (Indigenous Peoples' Day), last day of the season. Suggested donation $5 one way. If it isn't running, use the Sandbar bypass (see stage notes).

Alt. day 2, mile 47.5: Rouses Point–Lacolle 223 crossing

Open 8 AM to 8 PM daily on both sides (not 24 hours). Car booth; passport, EDL or NEXUS.

Lake Champlain Ferries: Essex, NY – Charlotte, VT

Early-fall 2026 schedule: from Essex every 30 min 10:30 AM to 5:30 PM, hourly 6:30 to 10:30 AM and 5:30 to 8:30 PM. Hourly all day from Nov 5. Check ferries.com the day before. $6.75 per cyclist, one way. Walk your bike on. Customer service: (802) 864-9804.

Local Motion Island Line Bike Ferry (Colchester Causeway 'Cut')

Fall 2026: Fri 10 AM to 5 PM, Sat and Sun 10 AM to 6 PM, Sep 11 to Oct 12 (Mon Oct 12 is the last day, 10 to 5). No Mon to Thu service. Suggested donation: $5 one way / $10 round trip.

Hours and closures

Business hours were checked online on 2026-09-27. October hours change often: call ahead before relying on a lunch stop or bike shop.

Emergency

Dial 911 in both the US and Canada. Each day's front page lists bail-out options (trains, buses, Metro).

About this plan

Replaces Days 5 and 6 of the 7-day tour (Thu Oct 8 and Fri Oct 9). Designed for the 7-day tour: the Local Motion bike ferry runs only Fri to Sun (plus Mon Oct 12), so the island day must fall on Fri Oct 9. On the 6-day plan this variant would make the last day about 111 mi. On the 5-day plan the island day would be a Thursday, when the bike ferry doesn't run.

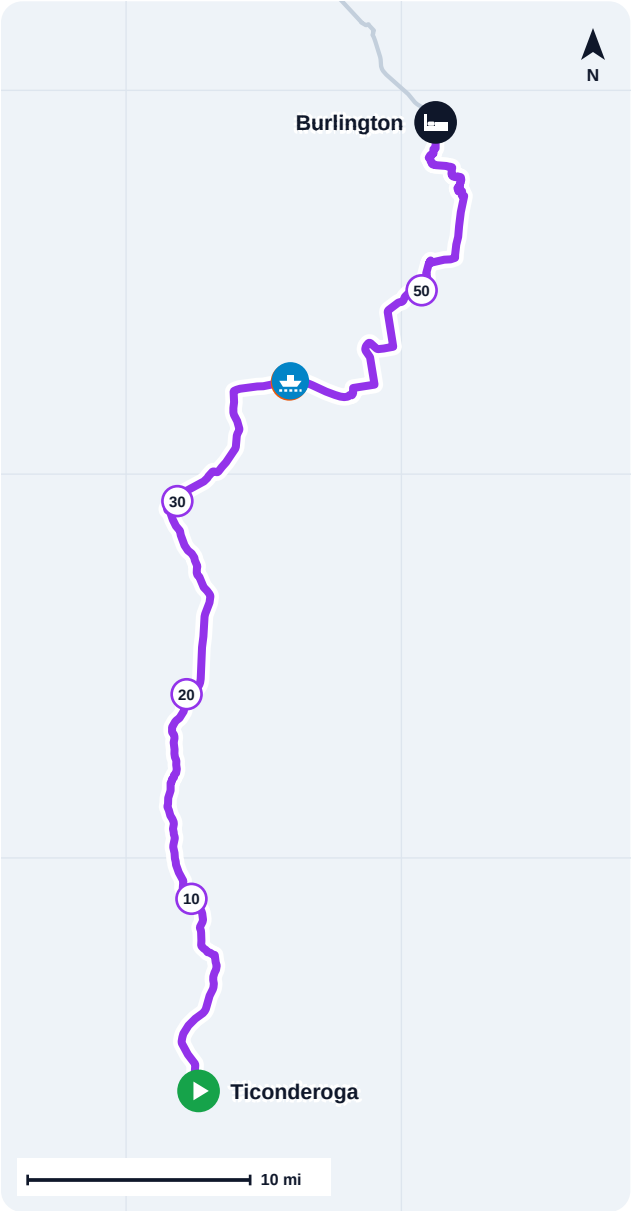
ALT. DAY 1 · THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8

Ticonderoga, NY to Burlington, VT (via Essex ferry)

NY-9N/22 to Essex, Essex–Charlotte ferry, Lake Champlain Bikeways (Greenbush Rd, Spear St), Burlington Greenway

61.1 MILES · **+2,500** FT CLIMB · **98** KM

Sunrise 6:58 AM · Sunset 6:24 PM



TONIGHT

Hotel Vermont

41 Cherry St, Burlington, VT · (802) 651-0080

Downtown, near the lakefront path.

Backup: Courtyard Burlington Harbor, (802) 864-4700

LUNCH

Pink Pig Cafe

Mile 38.9 · 2750 Essex Rd, Essex, NY · (518) 962-8833

Next to the ferry dock. Hours are limited in the fall (one listing shows Fri to Sun hours and closed Mon to Wed; Thursday is unclear): call ahead. The Essex Ice Cream Cafe is summer-only, and 'The Cup Cafe' from earlier drafts does not appear to exist.

ROAD & SURFACE

NY-9N/22 shoulders to Essex; a ferry crossing; quiet Vermont roads (Lake Rd, Greenbush Rd, Spear St) with about 1.4 mi on US-7 through Shelburne village; then paved paths into Burlington.

IF THINGS GO WRONG

Amtrak Adirondack at Port Henry (mile 15.1) before the ferry. In Burlington, Amtrak's Ethan Allen Express runs to NYC; check carry-on bike availability when booking.

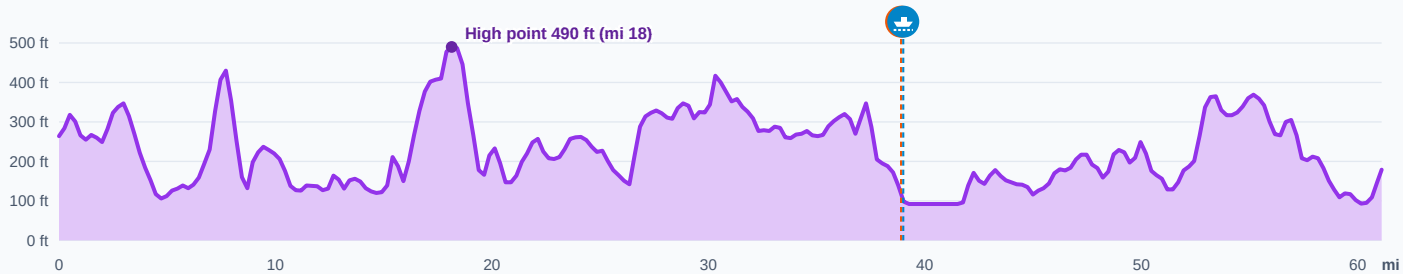
BIKE SHOPS

Old Spokes Home · (802) 863-4475

North Star Sports · (802) 863-3832

ELEVATION

+2,500 ft of climbing over 61.1 mi



ALT. DAY 1 · THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8

CUE SHEET · 61.1 MI · +2,500 FT

Ticonderoga, NY to Burlington, VT (via Essex ferry)

MILE	DO	ROAD / PATH	LEG	NOTES
0.0	Start on	Wicker Street (NY-9N)	1.3 mi	
1.3	Continue	State Highway 9N (NY-9N; NY-22)	5.6 mi	NY-9N/22 north along the lake.
6.9	Left	Sugar Hill Road	1.9 mi	
8.8	Continue	State Highway 9N (NY-9N; NY-22)	4.2 mi	
13.0	Continue	South Main Street (NY-9N; NY-22)	2.6 mi	Port Henry: Stewart's #103 for food and water.
15.6	Resupply	Stewart's #103, Port Henry	0.8 mi	Reliable food and water.
16.4	Continue	State Highway 9N (NY-9N; NY-22)	9.5 mi	
25.9	Right	Champlain Avenue (NY-22)	1.0 mi	
26.9	Continue	State Highway 22 (NY-22)	8.1 mi	
35.0	Continue	State Highway 9N (NY-22)	1.3 mi	
36.3	Continue	Station Road (NY-22)	1.1 mi	
37.4	Continue	Station Street (NY-22)	1.5 mi	
38.9	Lunch (Call Ahead)	Pink Pig Cafe, Essex (by the ferry dock)	0.1 mi	Fall hours are limited.
39.0	Ferry	Charlotte, VT - Essex, NY	2.8 mi	FERRY to Charlotte, VT: about 20 min crossing, $6.75 per cyclist. In the early-fall schedule, Essex departures run every 30 min 10:30 AM to 5:30 PM (hourly before and after).
41.8	Continue	Ferry Road (VT-F5)	1.4 mi	
43.2	Left	Lake Road	3.3 mi	Vermont: quiet Lake Champlain Bikeways roads.
46.5	Left	Greenbush Road	1.2 mi	
47.7	Continue	Bostwick Road	2.3 mi	
50.0	Left	Shelburne Road (US-7)	0.7 mi	
50.7	Left	Falls Road	0.2 mi	
50.9	Right	Shelburne Road (US-7)	0.8 mi	
51.7	Left	Webster Road	1.2 mi	
52.9	Left	Spear Street	2.9 mi	Spear St north into South Burlington.
55.8	Right	bike path	1.7 mi	
57.5	Right	Farrell Street	1.3 mi	
58.8	Right	Oak Beach Drive	0.3 mi	
59.1	Right	Burlington Greenway	0.4 mi	Lakefront path into downtown Burlington.
59.5	Left	Central Avenue	0.3 mi	
59.8	Left	Burlington Greenway	0.8 mi	
60.6	Right	Battery Street	0.5 mi	
61.1	Arrive	Hotel Vermont		41 Cherry St, Burlington, VT

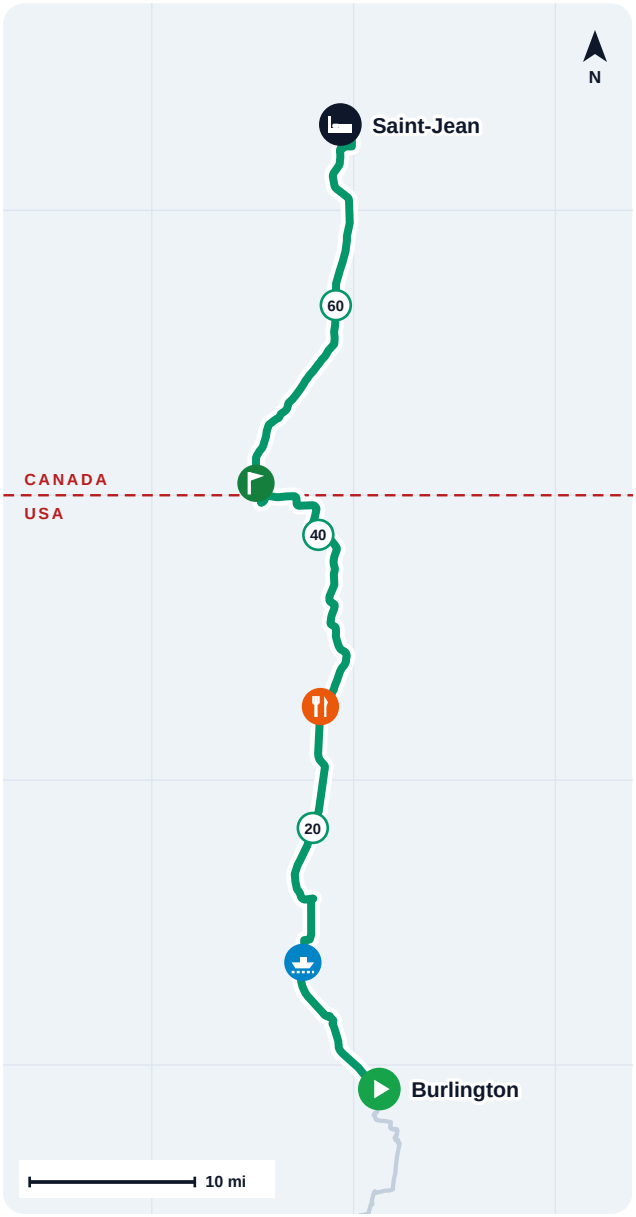
ALT. DAY 2 · FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9

Burlington, VT to Saint-Jean-sur-Richelieu, QC

Island Line Trail, Colchester Causeway, Local Motion bike ferry, Champlain Islands (US-2), Rouses Point, Route 223

72.8	+700	117
MILES	FT CLIMB	KM

Sunrise 6:59 AM · Sunset 6:21 PM



TONIGHT

Quality Hotel Centre de Congrès

725 Boul. du Séminaire N, Saint-Jean-sur-Richelieu, QC · +1 (450) 300-5177

North side of town, near the canal. Choice Hotels toll-free: 1-800-667-3815.

Backup: Auberge Harris, +1 (450) 348-3821

LUNCH

Hero's Welcome General Store

Mile 27.6 · 3537 US Route 2, North Hero, VT · (802) 372-4161

Deli, bakery and general store on the lake. Standard hours Mon to Sat 7 to 6, Sun 8 to 5; hours are reduced seasonally.

ROAD & SURFACE

Paved Island Line path; about 3 mi of crushed-stone causeway; a short bike ferry; then US-2 shoulders through the islands and flat Route 223 in Quebec. Unpaved per OpenStreetMap: about 4.9 mi (mi 6.6 to 10.3 fine gravel, mi 10.6 to 11.8 fine gravel/gravel).

IF THINGS GO WRONG

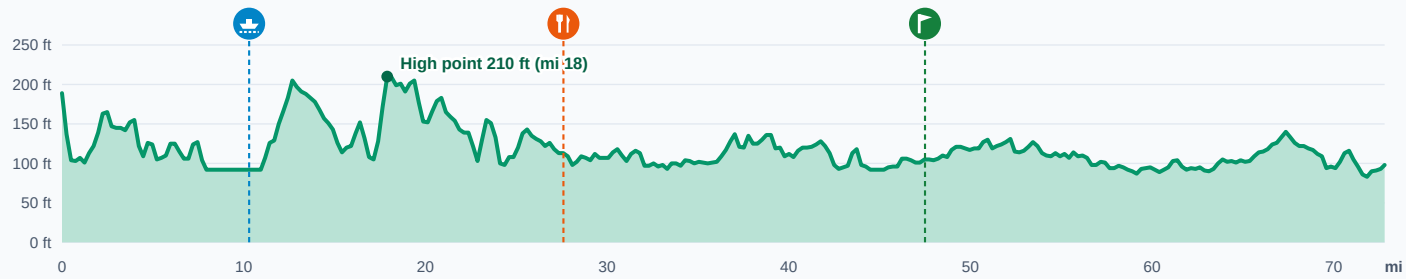
Amtrak Adirondack at Rouses Point (mile 46.4); southbound departs 2:15 PM, with no Monday service north of Saratoga.

BIKE SHOPS

Cycle LM (mi 72.8, 2.4 mi off route)

ELEVATION

+700 ft of climbing over 72.8 mi



ALT. DAY 2 · FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9

CUE SHEET · 72.8 MI · +700 FT

Burlington, VT to Saint-Jean-sur-Richelieu, QC

MILE	DO	ROAD / PATH	LEG	NOTES
0.0	Start on	Battery Street	0.3 mi	
0.3	Left	Burlington Greenway	4.9 mi	
5.2	Continue	Island Line Trail	0.5 mi	
5.7	Bear right	Windemere Way	0.2 mi	
5.9	Left	Biscayne Heights	0.4 mi	
6.3	Left	Colchester Point Road	0.4 mi	
6.7	Continue	Colchester Bike Path	0.6 mi	UNPAVED: FINE GRAVEL.
7.3	Continue	Colchester Causeway	3.0 mi	UNPAVED: FINE GRAVEL. Causeway into the lake: crushed stone, 3 mi.
10.3	Ferry	Local Motion Bike Ferry (Seasonal)	0.3 mi	BIKE FERRY across the Cut. 2026 fall schedule: Fri 10 AM to 5 PM, Sat and Sun 10 AM to 6 PM, through Mon Oct 12 (Indigenous Peoples' Day), last day of the season. Suggested donation $5 one way. If it isn't running, use the Sandbar bypass (see stage notes).
10.6	Continue	Island Line Trail	1.2 mi	UNPAVED: FINE GRAVEL/GRAVEL.
11.8	Right	Martin Road	0.3 mi	
12.1	Left	South Street	2.5 mi	
14.6	Right	U.S. Route 2 (US-2)	13.0 mi	US-2 north through the Champlain Islands.
27.6	Lunch	Hero's Welcome, North Hero	6.4 mi	General store, deli and bakery on the lake.
34.0	Continue	U.S. Route 2 South (US-2)	8.0 mi	
42.0	Continue	U.S. Route 2 North (US-2)	2.7 mi	
44.7	Continue	Rouses Point Bridge (US-2)	0.8 mi	US-2 bridge back into New York (Rouses Point).
45.5	Continue	Bridge Road (US-2)	0.2 mi	
45.7	Left	Montgomery Street	0.5 mi	
46.2	Left	Lake Street (US-11)	1.3 mi	US-11 north to the border.
47.5	Border	Rouses Point–Lacolle 223 crossing	0.2 mi	Open 8 AM to 8 PM daily on both sides (not 24 hours). Car booth; passport, EDL or NEXUS.
47.7	Bear right	Route 223	4.3 mi	CANADA. Route 223 north along the Richelieu.
52.0	Continue	Rue Principale (Route 223)	9.1 mi	
61.1	Continue	Route 223	3.7 mi	
64.8	Continue	Rue Jacques-Cartier Sud (Route 223)	1.8 mi	
66.6	Continue	Boulevard du Séminaire Sud (Route 223)	3.4 mi	
70.0	Left	Boulevard du Séminaire Nord (Route 223)	0.1 mi	
70.1	Right	Rue Saint-Georges	0.3 mi	
70.4	Right	Rue Saint-Jacques	0.5 mi	
70.9	Left	Rue Champlain	1.7 mi	
72.6	Left	Rue MacDonald	0.2 mi	
72.8	Arrive	Quality Hotel Centre de Congrès		725 Boul. du Séminaire N, Saint-Jean-sur-Richelieu, QC